



disaster, and sometimes people choose to migrate, perhaps for a better life or for work. As a result, different people come into contact with each other, languages and ideas spread, and over time ways

of life change and in their place new fashions and ideas are formed. These pages look in detail at some of the reasons why people choose to migrate or are forced to move.



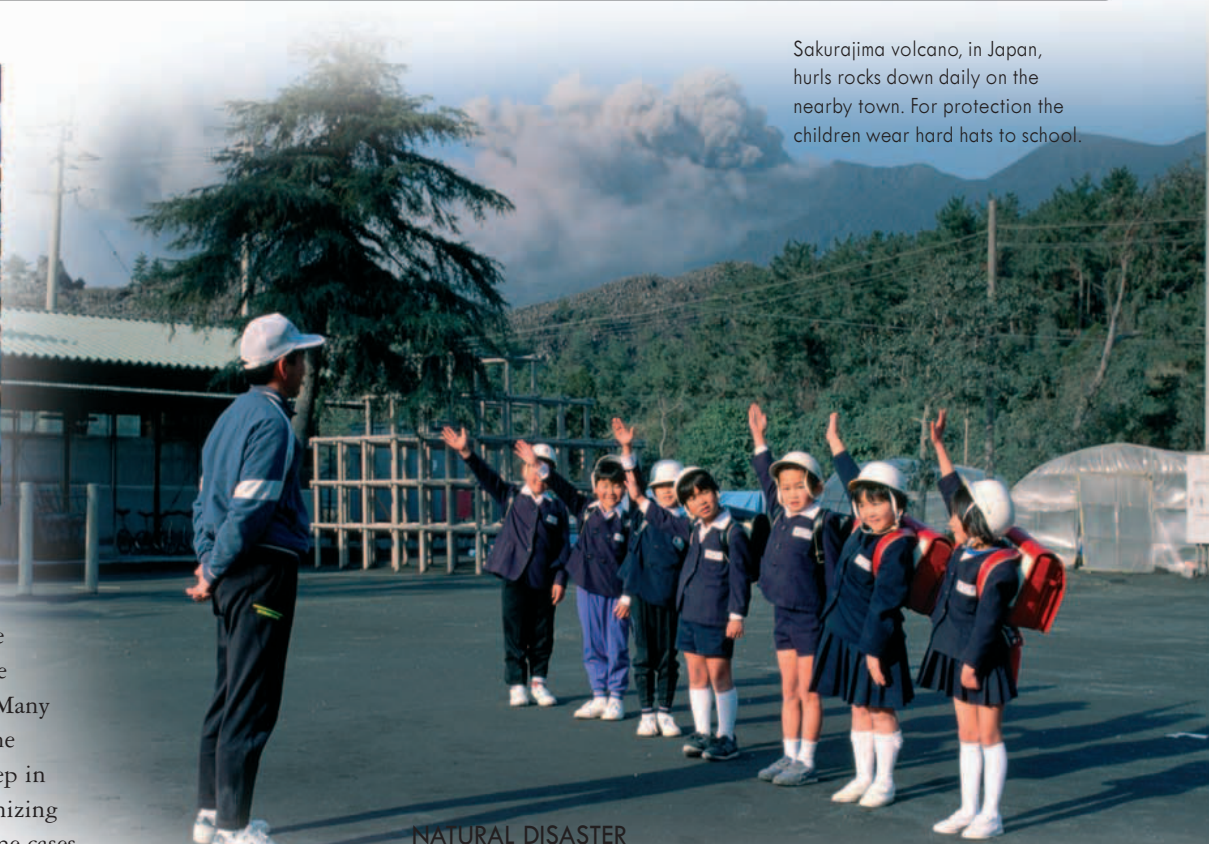
COLONIZATION

In the 16th, 17th, and 18th centuries Europeans conquered huge areas of the world, and large amounts of people moved to some of these areas, such as Australia. Many countries have since become independent but still keep in contact with their colonizing power and have in some cases adopted their language.



URBANIZATION

Cities often attract people from the surrounding countryside who are tempted by work. The city of Dubai, situated on the shores of Dubai Creek in the United Arab Emirates, has become a sprawling place due to businesses growing up around the oil industry. A valuable natural resource will attract people to an area.



Sakurajima volcano, in Japan, hurls rocks down daily on the nearby town. For protection the children wear hard hats to school.

NATURAL DISASTER

An earthquake, an eruption of a volcano, or a hurricane can be a reason for people to move. The aftermath of a natural disaster can often bring with it terror and chaos, forcing people to take up their belongings and leave. In 1995, a volcano on the island of Montserrat in the West Indies erupted and many people had to flee the island. Much of the island is still buried under ash today.

CHANGING POLITICAL BOUNDARIES

Some regimes place tight restrictions on movement. Until the late 1980s much of Europe, including East Germany, was ruled by the former communist power, the USSR. The people were unable to move freely until 1989, when the Berlin Wall came down, allowing movement once again.

